Daniel Vlad

DevOps Engineer | Cloud Solutions Architect

I am an experienced DevOps Engineer & Cloud Solution Architect specializing in Azure, with a strong background in consulting and customer support. I am committed to building strong customer relationships, delivering impactful solutions, and driving customer success through collaboration and innovation.

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Infrastructure Engineer, Azure DevOps

Roland Berger | Munich, Germany

05/2024 - present

- Leading the deployment of Microsoft Dev Box using an Infrastructure as Code (IaC) approach to enable scalable, secure, and developer-friendly environments.
- Supporting the modernization and cloud migration of legacy on-premises applications to Azure-native services such as Azure Container Instances (ACI), App Services, and Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS).
- Implementing CI/CD pipelines to provision custom OS security hardened Golden images with Azure Image Builder and deploying them to endpoints such as Microsoft Dev Box and self-hosted DevOps agents.
- Architect and deploying IoT-based monitoring solutions using Azure IoT Hub and IoT Central, enabling real-time visibility across distributed environments.
- Supporting the migration of GitLab CI/CD pipelines and Jira/Confluence to Azure DevOps, streamlining workflows and centralizing project management and delivery.
- Building and maintaining robust CI/CD pipelines to support rapid, reliable delivery of infrastructure and applications.

Support Escalation Engineer, Azure IaaS VMs

Microsoft | Bucharest, Romania

01/2022 - 05/2024

- Providing expert guidance to S500 customers and leveraging internal and public tools to resolve complex technical issues across multiple domains:
  - Storage - Azure Storage Accounts, Azure File Shares, Azure Blob Storage and Azure Disk Encryption.
  - Connectivity - OS issues on both Linux (Red Hat, SUSE, Ubuntu, and other supported distributions) or Windows, Network issues, etc.
  - Management - VM Performance and Migration from on premises to Azure.
  - Configuration and Setup - Troubleshooting deployment issues.
- Led troubleshooting of high-severity production cases, including no-boot scenarios, kernel panics, network issues, and misconfigurations, ensuring SLA compliance. Provided best-effort support and guidance on best practices, earning multiple Customer Hero recognitions and consistently high CSAT scores.
- Contributing to my team's success as an Escalation Point for Linux related issues, empowering colleagues and team members to offer the best customer experience through 1:1 sessions of coaching and mentorship.

SKILLS

- **Cloud Platforms**: Microsoft Azure, AWS, DigitalOcean, Google Cloud Platform.
- **Microsoft Azure Services**: AVD, Azure Image Builder, Dev Box, Azure Container Registry, WebApps, Azure Container Instances. **AWS Services**: EC2, EKS, ECR, IAM, VPC, S3.
- **Orchestration & Containers**: Kubernetes (K8s), AKS , EKS, Helm, Docker.
- **Infrastructure as Code (IaC)**: Terraform, Bicep, ARM Templates.
- **Build Automation, CI/CD & Artifacts**: Azure DevOps, Jenkins, GitLab, GitHub Actions, Git, Nexus Repository Manager, Docker Hub.
- **Security & Identity**: Microsoft Sentinel, Defender for Cloud, Entra ID, Conditional Access Policies, Privileged Identity Management, Intune, Zero Trust, MITRE ATT&CK® Framework.
- **Automation & Scripting**: Python, JavaScript, bash, PowerShell, RPA (UiPath).
- **Configuration Management** with Ansible.
- **Monitoring**: Prometheus, Grafana, New Relic.
- **Programming basics**: Python, JavaScript, Algorithms and Datastructures.
- **Build Tools & Package Managers**: - Build Artifacts (Java: Gradle, Maven, Python: pip, JavaScript: npm, yarn)
- **Operating Systems**: Linux (Ubuntu/RHEL/SUSE), Windows Server.

CERTIFICATIONS

- TWN DevOps Bootcamp
- Azure DevOps Engineer Expert
- Azure Solutions Architect
- Azure Identity and Access Administrator Associate
- Azure Security Engineer Associate
- Azure Administrator Associate
- Azure Virtual Desktop

EDUCATION

Law - Bachelor's Degree
Romanian - American University | Bucharest, Romania
09/2009 - 06/2014

ONGOING DEVELOPMENT

- SC 100 - Microsoft Cybersecurity Architect
- SAL1 - Security Analyst - TryHackMe

LANGUAGE

- English (C2), German (A2)

PROJECTS

- Automated Enterprise Image Lifecycle management.
- Developer Workstations (DevBox) landing zone.
- Architect a Secure Remote Workspace & Browser Isolation - AVD, Edge Streamed App.
- Build Automation & CI/CD with Jenkins - Deploying a complete pipeline for Java-Maven application with dynamic version increment to an EC2 instance.
- Create a Jenkins Shared Library to extract common build logic and functions that will be called in the Jenkins pipeline
- Deploy MongoDB and Mongo Express into local K8s Cluster
- Deploy Mosquitto message broker with ConfigMap and Secret Volume Types
- Install a stateful service (MongoDB) on Kubernetes using Helm
- Deploy web application in K8s cluster from private Docker registry
- Deploy Microservices application in Kubernetes with Production & Security Best Practices
- Create Helm Chart for Microservices
- Deploy Microservices with Helmfile
- Create AWS EKS cluster with a Node Group
- Create EKS cluster with Fargate profile
- Create EKS cluster with eksctl
- CD - Deploy to EKS cluster from Jenkins Pipeline
- CD - Deploy to LKE cluster from Jenkins Pipeline
- Complete CI/CD Pipeline with EKS and private DockerHub registry
- Complete CI/CD Pipeline with EKS and AWS ECR
- Configure a Shared Remote State
- Complete CI/CD Pipeline with Terraform
- Programming with Python - Write a Countdown Application
- Automation with Python - API Requests to GitLab
- EC2 Health Checks using Python, Boto3, and Terraform
- Automate configuring EC2 server instances using Python
- Automate displaying EKS cluster information
- Automate Data Backup & Restore of EC2 volumes using Python
- Automate Website Monitoring and Recovery using Python
- Automate Node.js application Deployment using Ansible
- Automate Nexus Deployment using Ansible
- Automation: Deploy EC2 instance using Terraform and automate Tech stack
- Installation and configuration using Ansible
- Ansible Integration in Terraform - Execute Ansible Playbook automatically
- Configure Dynamic Inventory with Ansible
- Automate Kubernetes Deployment using Ansible
- Ansible Integration in Jenkins
- Structure Playbooks with Ansible Roles
- Install Prometheus Stack in Kubernetes
- Configure Alerting and Monitoring for Applications using Prometheus